

TIMELINE JAN 1965–SEP 1967

Allied operations ■ **Elections in South Vietnam** ■ Protests in the United States ■ **Operation Rolling Thunder** ■ First battle for US ground troops ■ **Helicopters and aircraft** ■ Search-and-destroy tactics ■ **The Iron Triangle** ■ Pacification in South Vietnam

“[Now] **enemy forces are larger;** attacks, terrorism and sabotage have **increased** in scope and intensity ... **we control little,** if any, more of the population ... ”

DEFENSE SECRETARY ROBERT MCNAMARA, MEMORANDUM, OCTOBER 14, 1966